SpeechGeek

Season Three: Fall 2005

ISSN 1545-9209 Price $25 US
http://www.speechgeek.com

SpeechGeek.com

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ISSN 1545-9209

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SpeechGeek is published three to four times per year: August, October, December, and (sometimes) April by Corey Alderdice, 959 Morgantown Rd., Apt. 3, Bowling Green, Kentucky 42101

http://www.speechgeek.com

One of our goals in publishing **SpeechGeek** is to introduce the forensic world to new and talented writers. Traditional publishers often neglect promising writers. Other publishers are often clueless as to the needs of forensics performers. The material found in **SpeechGeek** is written by veteran and new forensic students and coaches. We strive to provide a product that is fresh and challenges the conventions of what makes a great performance. The most rewarding part of this process is that the material is left in your hands to make the final decision. You get to explore the emotions, characters, and stories. We may provide the material, but the end result is completely up to you. **Season Three starts here and what a season it will be!**

Corey Alderdice
Publisher

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Pipe Dreams

by Andy Birge

NARR. In a time long past, there once lived a man and his brother with the ability to make right where there was once wrong, peace where there was chaos, and nothing where there was once spaghetti. These that I speak of are the brothers Mario...

LUIGI. Wait! Why does it have to be all about Mario? Mario....Mario...Mario...

NARR. But isn't your last name Mario?

LUIGI. Well...yeah, but I mean...WHAT KIND OF NAME IS MARIO MARIO ANYWAY? (*turns away sobbing*)

(Toadstool wanders into the room.)

TOAD. Hhhheeey guys...you got any candy? (*staggers*)

LUIGI. What's up Toadstool? Look at me. Let me see your eyes. Are you drunk again?

TOAD. Yeah. So?

LUIGI. SO, it's 9:30 in the morning.

TOAD. Hey, let me tell you something, I love you man...No, I mean it...I really love you man...(*mumbles off*)

LUIGI. Have you paid the utilities yet?

NARR. Like I was saying before, the Mario Brothers have revolutionized our world as well as the Mushroom Kingdom. I am here today with Luigi Mario, faithful sidekick and brother to the world famous Mario Mario. So, Luigi, I see that you have gained a few pounds since we last saw you. What happened?

LUIGI. Well, mainly, I was tired of maintaining my image. After our life story was made into a movie, my reputation was ruined. I attribute the fall of my career to John Leguizamo. Hollywood wanted to make me seem like the pansy sidekick. Back in the day, I ran the game.

NARR. So, what have you and the crew been up to over the past fifteen years?

LUIGI. Well, Mario and I don't speak much since the plumbing business went down the drain. No pun intended. Since he went on the Atkin's diet, he thinks he's too good for me, rolling in royalties and spaghetti sauce. He doesn't eat the noodles anymore, though—or the mushrooms.

NARR. No mushrooms?

LUIGI. Well, the mushrooms from the Kingdom are *really* high in carbs. Haven't you seen that fool? He's emaciated, but he still has the best parties, I'll give him that. Everyone's there...me and Toad, the Princess, all the goombas, Bowser...

NARR. Bowser?

LUIGI. Oh, Bowser gave up his life of crime long ago when he married. It's shunned upon and everything--marrying outside of the game. It's an issue to some, but I don't care.

(Cut to interview with Bowser, AKA King Koopa.)

BOWSER. There is only one way. We must find the light that lies within us in order to find our ultimate purpose. Isn't that right, honey?

WIFE. Of course, Bowzie.

NARR. So tell me, how did you meet?

BOWSER. Well, one day I was at the bottom of a castle throwing fireballs at tourists and I realized I was missing something. A hole that no fireball could fill: the hole of true love. In the past, every woman I abducted was rescued, but this time, I knew she would rescue me.

NARR. So....*how* did you meet?

My Other

by Ingram Black and Dean Allen

Nick Franks: mid-twenties, advertising specialist
Christopher/Christine Franks: late twenties, entrepreneur, small business owner

—teaser—

NICK. (*talking to the maitre 'de*) I...um, I am a little late. Sorry, but I am looking for a Christopher Franks. He was expecting me. He should actually already be here. No, not Christine, Chris*topher*...it's my brother...

CHRIS. And she's been waiting for over twenty minutes.

NICK. I'm sorry...do I know you? Have we met before?

CHRIS. Well, I should think so. We only took baths together from the time we were two.

NICK. WHAT?

CHRIS. Nick...it's me.

NICK. Me, who?

CHRIS. Chris. (*Nick gives weird look*). Well, Christine.

NICK. WHaaa? (*Christine laughs*). Prove it.

CHRIS. You used to masturbate to the JC Penny catalog.

NICK. Hungry?

CHRIS. Famished.

—intro—

NICK. So...how are things?

CHRIS. Oh, fine. My little coffee shop has evolved into quite the java house.

NICK. Oh, good.

CHRIS. You're staring.

NICK. Yes, I am. I'm sorry I was just uninformed that you were a...a...

CHRIS. A woman?

NICK. Yeah, that pretty much...nails it.

CHRIS. Problem?

NICK. No, I mean, yes I'm uncomfortable but...I'm sorry Chris—

CHRIS. Christine.

NICK. Yeah, um right, I'm just in shock that's all. It's fine really it is...

CHRIS. Okay, how 'bout a quick change of subject then?

NICK. I'm afraid to ask...

CHRIS. I have a favor to ask.

NICK. I'm not dressing in drag and being your twin.

CHRIS. Worse. Actually, I'm looking for some help, a roommate of sorts for the next couple months or so. Just help around the shop, free room and board.

NICK. Chris—

CHRIS. —tine—

NICK. —Whatever. Look I haven't heard from you in five years. You can't just expect to suddenly reappear and I jump at the chance to be some kind of servant or something. I mean, I have a job, a good job, and I can't just up and leave. Are we talking two weeks...six months...a year?

CHRIS. It depends.

NICK. What do you mean it depends? You either know or you don't. It's not a difficult question here. I mean, c'mon, Chris, who the hell do you think you are? I...

CHRIS. I'm dying Nicky.

NICK. What? How do you know...

CHRIS. I have—

NICK. Let me guess—AIDS, right? How perfect.

CHRIS. Screw you, Nick. Can you get anymore stereotypical here? You know not all gay men contract AIDS. We can die from things other than our sexuality. For some reason I expected you to actually know that...

NICK. I'm sorry, Chris. I really am, I don't know what came over me. God, you tell me that you're dying and I proceed to insult you...

CHRIS. I know it's not easy, that it'll take some getting used to.

NICK. So, what's your disease of choice?

CHRIS. Hepatitis C.

NICK. Is that common? Because I've never even heard of that...

CHRIS. It's becoming more...popular. Remember when I had my appendix out in like the 8th grade? Part of the blood used in the transfusion was contaminated.

NICK. Why didn't you do something sooner?

CHRIS. The earliest symptom is fatigue, I thought I was just like everyone else...tired...I didn't know. In the advanced stages the symptoms become more obvious, but by then...

NICK. How long?

CHRIS. Not very, couple months at most, and that's why you're here. I know I haven't been there, Nicky...I don't deserve this but...just think about it, okay?

NICK. What? You're my brother, Chris; I have no choice but to be there. Listen, you might've been away becoming...who you are...but you will always be my brother.

CHRIS. I always knew you liked me.

NICK. Don't push it! (*smirks*) And by the way can I still call you brother? Or sister? Or my—

CHRIS. —other.

—scene change---(*Christine's coffee shop, both cleaning up shop*)

NICK. It has come to my attention that this coffee crap is a lot harder than one would think, and I hate washing these huge bowls you call cups...

CHRIS. Well, it's not exactly the advertising agency but I like it.

NICK. So, how long have been doing this?

CHRIS. Dressing as a woman or running a coffee shop?

NICK. Both.

CHRIS. 4 ½ years for either question. Okay, Mr. Advertising..what do you think of my new poster?

NICK. (*turns and reads*) For her final performance at the Pussy Cat Club, Angelina Dynasty...the Matron of Drag...will delight you with her presence on Friday, October 23. Who is Angelina Dynasty?

CHRIS. Me.

NICK. Where is the Pussy Cat Club?

CHRIS. Here. It transforms on Friday's.

NICK. I see. Are you sure you're up to that?

CHRIS. Oh, honey...I live for this...it's what keeps me going. Besides, my number one fan will be there...won't you...you will be there, right?

NICK. And miss Angelina's final performance...why it would be a travesty to the Drag community.

CHRIS. Thank you very much...and back to the dishes!

—scene change—

NICK. Hey, Chris! I mean Angelina Dynasty, Queen of the Sugar Tits...God who comes up with these names? Ugh, you ready in there? Chris, hey...(opens door) Chris? You okay?

CHRIS. I don't know if I can do this.

NICK. Hey, what is it? Why aren't you ready yet?

CHRIS. I can't stop shaking, my hands they're....I can't go out there without my face on. I need my make-up. It's my last chance to really be me and this body is stopping me from it...What am I going to do Nicky? I...

NICK. Shhh, it's okay, Chris. We can do this. We've made it this far and we're not giving up now.

CHRIS. But how?

NICK. Just tell me what to do. I've never done make-up before, but how hard can it be? Besides, I've watched you for the past three months...

CHRIS. Base first. Use the little sponge and just dab it around the eyes especially.

NICK. This one?

CHRIS. Right.

NICK. That okay?

CHRIS. Perfect. Next, blush. Use the second largest brush, sweep it back and forth, tap it to get off excess and then brush it across my cheekbones. Good...a touch on my nose and forehead....

NICK. Okay...got it.

CHRIS. Powder next, um there's a puff just use that and put it all over, just pat it...find the largest of the eye brushes, okay use that one to apply my eyeshadow.

NICK. Where do I...

CHRIS. Right under the eyebrow and sweeping downward. Good. Eye liner is tricky so take your time, apply it from the outer corner in...

NICK. Like this?

CHRIS. Uh-huh. Done?

NICK. Yeah.

CHRIS. Bottom eye, too.

NICK. Um...okay.

CHRIS. Mascara's too messy, so just use the eyebrow brush clean off my eyebrows.

NICK. Which one is that?

CHRIS. Right there, yeah that one. And finally lips. Just use the pencil and line them, then fill it in some...

NICK. There. Done...I think.

CHRIS. How do I look?

NICK. Good.

CHRIS. Do I get to see?

NICK. Oh, um...here

CHRIS. Perfect. Now, if I can just stop this shaking everything will be great.

NICK. They're ready for you, crowds going crazy I tell you. Knock 'em dead.

CHRIS. Right. Nick?

NICK. Yeah?

CHRIS. Thank you.

ICK. Anytime.

—scene change—

NICK. *(as announcer)* And now queens and kings, the Pussy Cat Club is proud to present for her final show the delectable, delicious, delightful....Angelina Dynasty!

CHRIS. (*really playing to the crowd*) Hello, DARLINGS! Well, well, well...look what the cat drug in....ME! (*laughs*) Have you missed me? Oh, I have missed you! But tonight...tonight is a very special night. It will be my final walk at the Pussy Cat Club. Oh, you're too kind to be so sad! Joining me tonight for my final sashay is my little brother...Nick!

NICK. Ugh...no, that's okay. I am completely busy cleaning cups...

CHRIS. Oh...now you wouldn't want to disappoint my queendom now would

you? On this cat walk now or I will just die! Literally! (*chanting*) Nick, Nick, Nick...oh that's my boy! Now, Nick...you do know how to sashay don't you?

NICK. No.

CHRIS. Oh, a virgin! Try it with me...then we gotta give it some punch. It's all in the hips...and the butt...(*laughs*) now right, left, right, left, turn like a star, and pose.

NICK. (*to him, as an aside*) This is too much, Chris...

CHRIS. For one night, just let it go....for me. Right, left, right, left, turn and pose. OH! OH! Wasn't he wonderful!?!? (*Nick leaves stage, still watching*) And now queens and kings the time has come for Angelina Dynasty to say farewell. And so without further ado, I bid you goodnight....and goodbye.

NICK. (*softly, to Christine*) Bye, Chris...